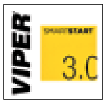


Viper SmartStart app
Viper's SmartStart 3.0 app lets iPhone users use Siri to perform many remote functions on their car, including starting it

Google to combine Ads?
Google CEO Larry Page suggested that the company might combine its Mobile and Desktop Ads to offer users greater seamless experience

Corsair Neutron GTX SSD 240GB and Corsair Neutron 240GB SSD

A best performer in our midst

Corsair has been coming out regularly with SSDs across all categories. We had found the Force GS series to be a fabulously performing drive thanks to the Toggle-mode NAND flash memory being used. With the Neutron series, Corsair is moving on from the SandForce controller that was seen in its other series of drives, to use a new controller from Link-A-Media - the LM87800. It features an eBoost technology which claims to improve the NAND chip lifespan.

The difference between the Neutron GTX and Neutron series of drives is the type of NAND memory being used. The more expensive Neutron GTX houses 8 Toshiba Toggle-mode NAND chips with a 32 GB capacity per chip whereas the Neutron drive has 16 Micron synchronous NAND chips each with a capacity of 16 GB. While the Neutron GTX drive has chips on only one side of the PCB, the Neutron drive has eight chips on either side. Apart from the memory, the PCB has the LM87800 controller alongwith its DRAM controller.

Test Setup

- Processor: Intel Core i7-3770K @ 3.5 GHz
- Motherboard: ASRock Z77 Extreme4
- Graphics Card: AMD HD 6850
- RAM: 2 x 4 GB Kingston HyperX RAM @ 1333MHz
- Monitor: BenQ EW2430

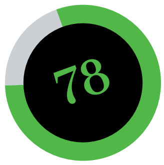
Starting things off with the ATTO benchmark which measures transfers across a specific volume length. We kept the test parameters at default from 0.5 KB to 8192 KB with the total length being 256MB. We noticed that the read speeds were quite good with both the drives giving a speed of 555 MB/s. The write speeds were better in the Neutron GTX drive, which gave 511 MB/s, whereas the Neutron drive maxed out at 370 MB/s. These speeds were completely in sync with what was advertised on the cover. Moving onto the Crystal Disk Mark 3.0 testing, we found that the 32-thread 4k read/write performance which corresponds to numerous small file transfers was almost identical on both the drives: 357MB/s read and 339 MB/s write which was quite good. Random 512k read speeds were lower than the Corsair Force GS series drive but the random 512k write speeds were better with the Neutron GTX giving 448 MB/s which is much better than 291 MB/s offered by the Force GS series SSD. That's because the LM87800 controller does not employ real-life compression while writing data as is done by the SandForce controller based drives. When it comes to sequential read speeds, the Force GS drive performed better.

In the AS SSD benchmark, the overall score of both the Neutron drives is really good at 1000 plus as compared to 657 of the Force GS series drive, as well as the Intel Series 520 drive which put up a score of 771. Apart from write operations, both drives perform within the margin of error.

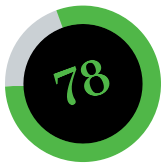
Corsair Neutron GTX 240GB SSD has been the best SSD we have tested so far. It wins the Best Performer tag from the Intel Series 520 SSD for its great overall performance. The Corsair Neutron 240 GB offers good performance, taking a hit only with write operations. But when you compare the write speeds on the Neutron with other SSDs that we tested, they were pretty impressive.

The Neutron GTX costs ₹18,200 and the Neutron costs ₹15,300. The Neutron GTX offers a decent performance jump over the Neutron series when it comes to write speeds, but is below Force GS when it comes to sequential operations. So, users who do not want to spend a ₹2,800 premium on the GTX series drive can opt for the Neutron drive, which is still better value for money than the Neutron GTX as well as the Force GS drive. A 5-year warranty on both drives is a surefire plus.

Nimish Sawant



Corsair Neutron GTX 240 GB
Features 80
Performance................ 85
Build Quality................ 80
Value for money.......... 65



Corsair Neutron 240 GB
Features 80
Performance................ 75
Build Quality................ 80
Value for money.......... 70

Specifications

Corsair Neutron GTX 240 GB
Unformatted Capacity: 223.57 GB; **Interface:** SATA 3; **Controller:** LAMD LM87800; **Memory:** 8x 32GB Toshiba

Corsair Neutron 240 GB
Unformatted Capacity: 223.57 GB; **Interface:** SATA 3; **Controller:** LAMD LM87800; **Memory:** 16x 16GB Micron

Contact

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